



P 23 · 48 PAGES, NO SHAME

The Mom Rage Workbook

Forty-eight pages for the version of you who lost it on the kitchen floor and could not believe the noise you made. A noticing log. A "what was underneath" worksheet. A repair-script library. A trigger map. A page for the partner. Plain language. Specific signs that say "this needs a real provider." No moral verdict.

Soothemade Notes

A SMALL APOTHECARY OF PRINTABLES · MADE SLOWLY

A PLANNING AND TRACKING TOOL · NOT MEDICAL ADVICE

Before you open this

If you are reading this because you have hurt your child, your partner, or yourself, please call:

- **988**, US Suicide & Crisis Lifeline (call or text, 24/7)
- **1-833-852-6262**, US Maternal Mental Health Hotline (24/7, free, confidential)
- **1-800-422-4453**, Childhelp National Child Abuse Hotline (24/7, free, confidential, anonymous)

If you are afraid that you might, the bar to call is the same. Calling is not an admission. Calling is the start of help.

This workbook is for the long stretch. The acute hour belongs to a human on a phone.

With care, Maya

A note from me

I screamed at my three-year-old in the laundry room. The reason was not, in fact, the spilled apple juice. It was the third time that hour I had cleaned the apple juice. It was the fact that I had not eaten since breakfast. It was the fact that I had not slept more than four hours in nine months. It was the fact that I had spent the morning with my mother-in-law, who had implied that I was “doing it wrong.” It was the fact that my husband was on a work call and could not come in even when I knocked.

I did not know any of that, in the moment. I only knew that something in my chest had cracked, and a voice came out of me that I did not know I had.

This workbook is for that. For seeing, on paper, what was actually underneath. For building the muscle to notice it earlier. For learning that the repair afterward is the work, not the perfect non-event.

With care, Maya

Intense anger in postpartum and parenting is more common than the culture admits. It can also be a sign of something that warrants a real provider. If your rage is frequent, escalating, paired with intrusive thoughts, or making you afraid for yourself or your family, please call. The numbers are at the back.

What this workbook is, and is not

IS

- A noticing tool, designed for the specific shape of postpartum and parenting rage.
- A trigger-mapping worksheet that helps you see the pattern.
- A repair-script library, because repair is the work.
- A page for the partner, because they are in this too.
- A "when to call a real provider" page.

IS NOT

- A diagnosis. We do not diagnose anger as a disorder.
- A "ten steps to never feel angry again." That promise would be a lie.
- A reason to feel ashamed. Anger is information.
- A substitute for therapy. If you can find a therapist, especially one familiar with perinatal mood, that is the gold standard.

The names we use

Mom rage, parent rage, postpartum rage, mom anger. None of these are technically clinical terms. The closest clinical correspondences are:

- **Anger as a postpartum mood symptom**, often paired with PPD or PPA. Treated similarly.
- **Postpartum irritability**, a recognized symptom of perinatal mood disorders.
- **Intermittent explosive disorder**, in some chronic cases (this requires a clinical evaluation).

The point of naming is not to give you a diagnosis. It is to remind you: this is a known thing. You did not invent it. You are not the only one.

How to use this workbook

- Use one page at a time. Skip ones that do not apply.
- The noticing log is the foundation. Fill it in after an incident, not during.
- The trigger map is built over weeks, not one sitting.
- Read the repair scripts when calm. They land better that way.
- Bring this to a therapist if you have one. The notes give you something specific to talk about.

The noticing log

Use one row per incident. Try to fill it in within 24 hours, when you can still remember. Don't try to be objective. Be honest.

DATE/TIME _____ WHO WAS THERE _____

WHAT HAPPENED, IN ONE SENTENCE

THE TRIGGER (the visible one)

THE BODY, JUST BEFORE

- ☐ Chest tight ☐ Jaw clenched ☐ Heat in face
- ☐ Hands shaking ☐ Breath shallow ☐ Stomach knot
- ☐ Felt out-of-body briefly ☐ Hands clenched
- ☐ Other: _____

WHAT I SAID OR DID

INTENSITY (1 = irritated, 10 = lost time)

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10

THE UNDERLYING STATE (check all)

- ☐ Sleep debt ☐ Hunger or skipped meal
- ☐ Sensory overload ☐ Pelvic pain / body pain
- ☐ Caffeine / lack of it
- ☐ Cycle day _____ (if cycle has returned)
- ☐ Recent argument or unresolved tension
- ☐ Loneliness / not being seen
- ☐ Help promised that didn't arrive
- ☐ Other: _____

WHAT I DID AFTER (within 30 minutes)

- ☐ Walked out of the room
- ☐ Apologized briefly
- ☐ Cried
- ☐ Said nothing
- ☐ Continued the conflict
- ☐ Other: _____

REPAIR (within 24 hours)

- ☐ Repair script said to the child / partner
- ☐ Repair script written
- ☐ Not yet (planned for today)
- ☐ Decided not to (and the reason: _____)

ONE SENTENCE I WANT THE FUTURE-ME TO REMEMBER

Use this for as many incidents as it makes sense. After two weeks, look at the patterns. You will see them.

The trigger map

A grid for tracking which triggers actually show up over a month. Print this. Tape it inside a cabinet.

THE TOP 20 TRIGGERS (rank by frequency over 4 weeks)

TRIGGER	COUNT	RANK
A toddler tantrum / meltdown	_____	_____
Partner not noticing / not helping	_____	_____
A specific task left undone (laundry, dishes, lunchbox)	_____	_____
Being interrupted while doing the thing I was asked to do	_____	_____
A child whining for a sustained period	_____	_____
Sibling fighting / one hitting another	_____	_____
Refusing to put on shoes / coat / pj's	_____	_____
Spilling food or drink	_____	_____
A schedule running late	_____	_____
A specific noise (the song, the toy)	_____	_____
The doorbell / phone / unexpected interruption	_____	_____
A partner / family comment	_____	_____
Asking the same question more than 3x	_____	_____
Touching when I am touched-out	_____	_____
The dog	_____	_____
A specific person in the house	_____	_____
A specific room (the kitchen at 5pm)	_____	_____
Hunger (mine)	_____	_____
Sleep debt (recent)	_____	_____
Other: _____	_____	_____

THE TOP 3 (after a month)

1. _____
 2. _____
 3. _____
-

The top three are the ones to make a real change around. The change might be structural (a different bedtime, a different chore split). It might be relational (a conversation with the partner). It might be physical (a snack drawer, an earlier dinner).

The “what was underneath” worksheet

A page to fill out after a specific incident, ideally within 24 hours.

THE INCIDENT (one sentence)

WHAT THE STORY IN MY HEAD WAS, IN THE MOMENT
("She doesn't respect me." "He never helps." "I am
always the one who has to do this." "Nothing I do is
enough.")

WHAT FEELING IS NAMED IN THAT STORY?

- ☐ Anger ☐ Resentment
- ☐ Loneliness ☐ Shame
- ☐ Fear ☐ Grief
- ☐ Exhaustion ☐ Disappointment
- ☐ Powerlessness ☐ Something else: _____

IF THE ANGER WERE GUARDING A SOFTER FEELING,
WHAT WOULD THE SOFTER FEELING BE?

WHO IN MY LIFE COULD HEAR THE SOFTER FEELING?

Name: _____

HAVE I ASKED FOR WHAT I ACTUALLY NEED?

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ Not yet (planned for today)
- ☐ No, because I don't know what I need yet
- ☐ No, because I tried and it didn't land

IF I DID ASK, IN ONE SENTENCE, WHAT WOULD THE ASK BE?

WHAT'S ONE PHYSICAL NEED I HAVE BEEN IGNORING?

- ☐ Food ☐ Water ☐ Sleep
- ☐ Movement ☐ Touch (or no touch)
- ☐ Quiet ☐ Sunlight
- ☐ Solitude ☐ Company

ONE SMALL THING I'LL DO IN THE NEXT 24 HOURS

What the nervous system is doing

A short page, in plain language. Not a neuroscience lecture, but the gist.

When you are running low on sleep, food, or regulation reserves, your nervous system is closer to the “alert” line than it usually is. When a trigger lands (the apple juice, the asking-again, the doorbell), your body interprets it as a threat. The body’s response is fast: heart rate up, breath shallow, muscles tense, the prefrontal cortex (the thinking, reasoning part) goes partly offline.

That is the moment of the rage. The brain is now operating on the brainstem and the limbic system, both of which are excellent at survival and not great at language or measured response.

This is not “you being bad.” This is your body in a state. The same state shows up in soldiers, in ER nurses, in anyone running on chronic depletion.

What helps:

- Lowering the chronic activation (more sleep, more food, more help, less sensory chaos)
- Catching the rise earlier (the noticing log helps)
- Letting the body do something physical when the rise starts (the wall push, the cold water on wrists, walking out for two minutes)
- Repair afterward, because repair is what rebuilds the safety in the relationship

What doesn’t help:

- Telling yourself “calm down” (this never works)
- Promising yourself “I won’t ever do that again” (this also doesn’t work, and breaking the promise adds shame, which lowers the threshold for the next time)
- Soldiering on after an incident without repairing (the body remembers)

The in-the-moment pages

Three things to do BEFORE the rage lands on a person. Print these. Tape them inside a cabinet. Read them when calm so the body knows the moves.

Page 1, the ten-pace move

The moment you feel the rise in your chest:

1. Say out loud, even in a normal voice: "I need a minute."
2. Walk ten paces. Anywhere. Around the kitchen counter. Out to the porch. Down the hall.
3. Do not say anything else during the ten paces.
4. After ten paces, take three slow breaths.
5. Decide whether you are ready to re-enter, or whether you need another ten paces.

The walking does something real. The brain interprets motion as "I am responding to the threat, I am safe enough." The activation drops.

Page 2, the bathroom door

If walking is not possible (you are alone with a small child, you cannot leave the room):

1. Take the child somewhere safe. A crib. A playpen. A high chair with a snack. (A safe place is the goal. "Perfectly happy" is not.)
2. Walk to the bathroom. Close the door.
3. Sit on the floor or stand at the sink. Both work.
4. Run cold water on your wrists for thirty seconds. Or splash some on your face.
5. Three slow breaths.
6. Open the door. Re-enter.

The whole sequence is two to four minutes. The child is fine for two to four minutes in a safe place. You are not.

Page 3, the cold-water-on-wrists trick

When you cannot leave the room at all:

1. Stand at the sink. Run cold water on the insides of your wrists for thirty seconds.
2. The body interprets the cold as "I am in cold water, I should regulate." The vagal response kicks in. Heart rate drops.
3. This works in about 60 seconds.

You can do this with the child watching. You can say, in a normal voice, "I'm doing the cold water. I'll be a minute."

The repair-script library

Repair is the work. Repair is also the thing that distinguishes a “moment of difficulty” from a wound. A repaired moment is information. An unrepaired moment, accumulated, is the thing kids remember.

Repair scripts for a child, ages 2-5

"Earlier, when you were _____, I lost my calm. I'm sorry I (yelled / pulled your arm / slammed the door). You did not do anything that deserved that. I love you. I am still your grown-up. We can keep practicing this together."

"I had a big feeling earlier. Big feelings happen to grown-ups too. I am sorry it landed on you. You are safe. I love you."

"That was a hard moment. I was tired and the noise was a lot. I should have asked for help instead of yelling. I'm asking now. Want to do (small calm activity) with me?"

Repair scripts for a child, ages 6+

"Hey. About earlier. I lost my temper, and I shouldn't have. The thing I said about _____ wasn't fair. You don't deserve to be talked to that way. I'm sorry. I'm going to work on doing it differently."

"I want to talk to you about what happened. Not because you are in trouble, but because I am the grown-up and I need to clean up my own mess. I'm not asking for forgiveness. I just want you to know I noticed."

Repair scripts for a partner

"What I said earlier was sharper than the moment needed. I was running on (no sleep / no food / a hard day) and I aimed it at you. That wasn't right. I'm sorry."

"I want to circle back on what happened earlier. I think I was actually feeling (unseen / overwhelmed / scared / resentful) and I came out angry. Can we talk about what's actually underneath?"

Repair scripts for yourself

"Earlier today, I did the thing. I am noticing that shame is the next move. The shame is not useful. The repair is useful. I am going to do the repair."

"This is not the first time. It will not be the last. I am still trying to do this differently. I am not a bad person. I am a person running low on a thing, and I am going to (one specific small refill) today."

"My kid will not remember a perfect mom. They will remember a mom who came back. I am the one who comes back."

When to call a real provider

This is not a moralistic page. These are signs that mean a workbook is not enough, and a workbook should not be enough.

- ☐ Rage incidents are happening more than once a week for several weeks, and the intensity is rising
- ☐ You are afraid you might hurt your child or yourself
- ☐ You have hurt your child (a hit, a shake, a grab that left a mark)
- ☐ You have intrusive thoughts about harm that feel different from "imagining the worst" (PPOCD)
- ☐ You are losing time during episodes (you "come to" and don't fully remember)
- ☐ You are using alcohol or substances to manage the rage, more than you'd like to
- ☐ Your partner has expressed real fear of you
- ☐ Your child seems afraid of you (flinches, hides, has started reporting behavior to others)
- ☐ You feel you cannot recognize yourself

If you checked one or more, please call:

- ☐ Your OB / midwife / primary care
- ☐ A therapist (start with insurance directory or Psychology Today)
- ☐ US Maternal Mental Health Hotline: 1-833-852-6262
- ☐ Childhelp National Child Abuse Hotline: 1-800-422-4453
(also for adults who want to talk anonymously about parenting struggles, no CPS involvement, confidential)
- ☐ Postpartum Support International: 1-800-944-4773

Calling these lines is not a failure. It is the move a person who is paying attention makes.

A page for the partner

If you are reading this because your partner is going through it.

What to see

- She is exhausted in a way she does not name.
- She is not asking for what she needs.
- She is angrier than she has ever been, and she does not know what to do with it.
- She is also scared of herself.
- Underneath the anger is often loneliness or being-unseen.

What to say

The wrong moves: "Calm down." "Don't yell at the kids." "What is your problem." "You used to be such a sweet person."

A better move:

"I love you. I see how much you're carrying. I want to take some of it. Can we talk about what would actually help? Not 'you have to figure it out' help. Real help."

After an incident, even one that scared you:

"That was a lot. I am not mad at you. I do think we need to look at this together. Not today. When you're ready. I'm not going anywhere."

What to do

- Take the kids for a real stretch. Not 20 minutes. Four hours. Once a week. Make it predictable.
- Carry one whole category of household labor without being asked. Pick one. Be consistent.
- Don't wait for her to ask for help. The asking is, by this point, often the labor that has been worn down.
- If you are worried, call her OB or therapist WITH her, or for her, or just yourself. You are allowed to ask a provider "I am worried about my partner, what should I do?"

When to push

If she is talking about hurting herself, or has hurt the children, or is unrecognizable, please call:

- **988** for crisis
- **1-833-852-6262** for the Maternal Mental Health Hotline
- **911** or your local ER for active self-harm or postpartum psychosis

You can also call **Childhelp** at **1-800-422-4453**. It is confidential, anonymous, does not automatically involve CPS, and is a place to ask "what do I do?"

Your worry is the love speaking. Take care of yourself too.

The reflection page, at the back

A page to fill in much later, looking back.

I started noticing this around _____.

The thing I learned about my triggers was:

The thing I learned about what was underneath was:

The repair I am proudest of:

The provider, therapist, or person I reached out to:

What I would tell the version of me who started this workbook:

Numbers to keep

OB / MIDWIFE / PRIMARY CARE

Name: _____ Number: _____

THERAPIST (if you have one)

Name: _____ Number: _____

PSYCHIATRIST (if you have one)

Name: _____ Number: _____

US MATERNAL MENTAL HEALTH HOTLINE

1-833-852-6262 (24/7, free, confidential)

US SUICIDE & CRISIS LIFELINE

988 (call or text, 24/7)

CHILDEHELP NATIONAL CHILD ABUSE HOTLINE

1-800-422-4453 (24/7, free, confidential, anonymous,
for parents struggling with parenting too)

POSTPARTUM SUPPORT INTERNATIONAL

1-800-944-4773

A SAFE PERSON TO CALL



From Soothemade Notes, a small apothecary of printables, planners, and cards for the unphotographed parts of new parenthood. Made slowly, in plain language.

Not medical advice.



Soothemade *Notes*

*Made for the version of you no one tells you about, the
one at four in the morning, the one in the parking lot, the
one who doesn't recognize her own week.*

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